



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

prakīrṇake punar jñeyā vyavahārā nṛpāśrayāḥ | 18.001a
rājñām ājñāpratīghātas tatkarmakaraṇaṁ tathā || 1 || 18.001c
purapradānaṁ sambhedaḥ prakṛtīnām tathaiva ca | 18.002a
pāṣaṇḍanaigamaśreṇīgaṇadharmaviparyayāḥ || 2 || 18.002c
pitṛputravivādaś ca prāyaścittavyatikramaḥ | 18.003a
pratigrahavilopaś ca kopa āśramaṇām api || 3 || 18.003c

— Nāradaśmṛti, Chapter 17, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Nāradaśmṛti, in this section, delves into a collection of miscellaneous legal matters, those that frequently involve the king or the state. It's a fascinating glimpse into the intersection of spiritual principles and the practical governance of society. When you look at these verses, you are essentially seeing the Dharma reflected in the laws governing interpersonal relationships and the relationship between the individual and the ruling power.

The text addresses the consequences of disobeying the king's orders, or conversely, of officials failing to carry out their duties. This highlights the importance of respecting legitimate authority while simultaneously emphasizing the responsibility that comes with power. Giving away a city, creating discord amongst the people, and deviations from the established customs of heretics, merchants, guilds, and assemblies are also mentioned. These seemingly disparate issues all touch upon the need for social harmony and the dangers of actions that could undermine the collective good.

Furthermore, the scripture addresses disputes between father and son, transgressions requiring penance, the misappropriation of gifts, and even the anger of ascetics. These diverse concerns underscore the interconnectedness of all aspects of life, from family dynamics to religious practices, and how legal frameworks must account for this complexity. In modern terms, this translates to understanding how your actions, even within your family, can have wider implications for your community and beyond. Consider how ignoring traffic laws (disobeying the king's order) can endanger others, or how unethical business practices (deviations from merchant customs) erode trust in society.

The essence of these verses is that Dharma isn't confined to temples or personal meditation; it is woven into the fabric of your daily interactions and decisions. Each action, each choice you make, has a ripple effect, influencing not only your own spiritual journey but the collective well-being of society. By upholding ethical principles and respecting just laws, you contribute to a more harmonious and spiritually fulfilling world.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you actively embody Dharma in your daily interactions, ensuring that your actions contribute to the well-being of both yourself and your community?